Start: letters a m s t · lesson 4 of 8 · 50 minutes

Meet /t/: top and tent

Today your child learns: I can say the quick sound /t/ for the letter t, hear /t/ at the start of top and tent, and clap the parts of words.



Standards: RF.K.3a, RF.K.3b, RF.K.1d, RF.K.2b, RF.K.2, RF.K.1b, RF.K.1, L.K.1a, L.K.2c, 10.5 K.A, 10.5 K.B, 10.5 K.C. Common Core State Standards © 2010 NGA Center and CCSSO.

10′ Sounds · 3′ Letters · 20′ New · 7′ Read · 10′ Write

Today at a glance

10 min	Sound games: clap and chin-drop the parts of spoken words.
3 min	Letter drill: a, m, s with name, sound, key picture.
20 min	New skill: the letter t says a quick /t/; circle /t/ pictures.
7 min	Reading together: Hello, School! shows spoken words are written with letters.
10 min	Handwriting: trace and write m, M, s, S from the green dot.

Get ready (2 minutes)

- Print: Meet the Letter t
- Print: Which Start with /t/?
- Print: Handwriting: m and s, day 4
- From the kit: a m s t letter cards, picture cards, M m and S s trace pages
- Hello, School! (day 1 copy), a pencil, a crayon

Printing in black and white? The green start dot is the big dot.

Tip for the grown-up

/t/ is a stop sound: say it as a tiny whispered puff, never 'tuh', and blending will come much more easily in two weeks. Praise the exact thing, like 'Quick /t/, perfect!'



Short on time? At home in 20 minutes

1. Clap the parts of turtle, map and magazine together, using the chin trick (3 minutes).
2. Flash the a, m, s kit cards while your child says name, sound and picture (2 minutes).
3. Show the t card and Meet the Letter t, say a quick /t/, then circle the /t/ pictures on Which Start with /t/? (7 minutes).
4. Read Hello, School! aloud and let your child tap and count the letters in two words (3 minutes).
5. Do the m, M, s, S rows on today's handwriting sheet, saying each path together (5 minutes).



SOUND GAMES

Sound games: clap the parts

10 min

Hear and count the parts (syllables) in spoken words. No letters, only listening.

Watch me I do it, you watch

SAY

Listen: turtle. Tur-tle. Two claps. Turtle has two parts.

Top. One clap. Top has one part.

Hand under my chin: tel-e-phone. Three chin drops. Three parts!

- Clap once per part as you say each word slowly. No letters out.
- Show the chin trick: hand flat under your chin, count each drop.

We do together

SAY

Hands under chins with me: muffin. Muf-fin. How many drops? Two!

Clap it together: map. One clap. One part.

Toothbrush. Tooth-brush. Clap with me. How many parts?

- Say each word first, then clap and count together; hold up fingers for the number.

You do the child alone

SAY

Your turn. I say a word, you clap it and tell me how many.

Sun. Taco. Magazine.

Now clap your own name. How many parts?

- Answers: sun 1, taco 2, magazine 3. Wait 3 seconds before you help.
- Extra round: jump once per part for tent, button, tornado.

If your child gets it wrong

- My turn: ta-co, two claps. Our turn: clap with me. Your turn: taco.
- If the child claps every sound, use the chin trick: one drop, one clap.



LETTER DRILL

Letter drill: a, m, s

3 min

Say the name, sound and key picture for a, m and s, small and capital, quickly.

Watch me I do it, you watch

SAY

This is the letter a. It says /a/, like apple.

Now the capital A card. Same sound: /a/.

The letter m says /m/, map. The letter s says /s/, sun.

- Hold up each kit letter card. Hold /m/ and /s/; keep /a/ short and clean.
- Keep the t card face down. It joins after today's new lesson.

We do together

SAY

Together: name, sound, picture. Ready?

The letter a, /a/, apple. The letter m, /m/, map. The letter s, /s/, sun.

- Say all three with the child, small letter then capital; tap the table once per card.

You do the child alone

SAY

Your turn. I point, you say name, sound, picture.

Fast now! Capitals and small letters mixed.

- Mix the six cards (A a M m S s) and point fast, one or two rounds.

If your child gets it wrong

- My turn: the letter s, /s/, sun. Our turn: together. Your turn: what is this?
- If you hear 'muh' or 'suh': 'Lips closed, just hum /m/' or 'Just a hiss /s/.' Retest.



NEW SKILL

New skill: meet /t/

20 min

Link the letter t to the quick sound /t/ and hear /t/ at the start of spoken words.

Watch me I do it, you watch

SAY

This is the letter t. It says /t/. Quick, like a whisper.

My tongue taps behind my top teeth: /t/. No 'tuh'.

Top. /t/, top. Top starts with /t/.

- Hold up the kit t card, then the Meet the Letter t sheet; point to top.
- Finger-trace T and t from the green dots, reading the exact path in the Letter paths box.

We do together

SAY

Say it with me, quick: /t/. One finger tap for a quick sound.

Tent, /t/. Turtle, /t/. Ten, /t/. They all start with /t/!

Thumbs up if it starts with /t/: top? fish? turtle? dog?

- Point to tent, turtle, ten on the sheet; finger-trace T and t together saying /t/.
- Sort kit cards top, tent, turtle, ten with fish, dog, hat, fan into two piles.

You do the child alone

SAY

Your turn. Name each picture. Circle the ones that start with /t/.

Say each word out loud first.

Last one: show me the t card. What sound?

- On Which Start with /t/?, the child names and circles; check with the answer key.
- Answers: tent, turtle, ten (not bus, egg, king). Add the t card to the kit pile.

Letter paths: say these words as you write

T Start at the top line. Pull straight down. Back to the top: slide right across.

t Start near the top line. Pull straight down. Cross at the middle line: slide right.

If your child gets it wrong

- My turn: tent, /t/, tent. Our turn: tent, /t/. Your turn: first sound in tent?
- If you hear 'tuh', hand by mouth: 'Just a tiny puff: /t/.' Then retest.



READING TOGETHER

Reading together: words are made of letters

7 min

Understand that the words we say can be written with letters, using Hello, School!

Watch me I do it, you watch

SAY

I say a word: mat. Now I show it with letters.

The letters m, a, t. The word I said is made of letters.

Every word we say can be written with letters.

- Lay kit cards m, a, t in a row; touch each, then sweep and say mat.

We do together

SAY

Here is the cover. I'll read it: Hello, School!

This word is Hello. Let's touch each letter together.

We said Hello, and here it is in letters.

- Read the cover, pointing under each word; guide the child's finger across each letter of Hello.

You do the child alone

SAY

I'll read this page. You listen and look.

Point to one word. Tap each letter. How many letters?

- Read 2 or 3 pages; read the word the child picks, then they tap and count letters.

If your child gets it wrong

- If the child taps the picture: 'That is the picture. Words are made of letters.' Guide to a word.
- If they tap a word once: 'My turn: one tap per letter.' Then together, then alone.

HANDWRITING

Handwriting: m, M, s, S

10 min

Form small and capital m and s top-down from the green dot, with a pinch-and-flip grip and the same words every time.

Watch me I do it, you watch

SAY

Small m: Start at the middle line. Pull down.

Push up, curve over, pull down. Push up, curve over, pull down.

Small s: Start just below the middle line. Curve back, then curve forward, like a snake.

- Show pinch and flip. Trace the kit M m and S s pages, saying each path.
- Start small m at the middle line, small s just below it, top-down.

We do together

SAY

Capital M: Start at the top line. Pull down.

Back to the top: slant down, slant up, pull down.

Capital S: Start just below the top line. Curve back, then curve forward, like a snake.

- Air-write all four big together, saying each path from its starting point.
- Trace the first letter in each row of today's handwriting sheet together.

You do the child alone

SAY

Pinch and flip. Sit tall, feet flat.

Trace three in each row, then write one alone from the green dot.

Whisper the path as you write.

- Watch the start and direction; praise one exact thing: 'You started at the green dot.'

Letter paths: say these words as you write

M	Start at the top line. Pull down. Back to the top: slant down, slant up, pull down.
m	Start at the middle line. Pull down. Push up, curve over, pull down. Push up, curve over, pull down.
S	Start just below the top line. Curve back, then curve forward, like a snake.
s	Start just below the middle line. Curve back, then curve forward, like a snake.

If your child gets it wrong

- Started at the bottom? 'My turn: from the green dot. Say the path in the box with me.' Our turn hand over hand, your turn.
- If the grip slips, say 'Pinch and flip' and reset before the next letter.

Quick check (2 minutes)

1. Show the kit t card and ask 'What sound?': listen for a quick /t/ with no 'uh'.
2. Say toy, moon, tub; the child gives a thumbs up only for words starting with /t/ (toy, tub).
3. Say pumpkin; the child claps it and tells you how many parts (2).

Got it

3 of 3: tomorrow run the review game and the Friday weekly check as planned.

Nearly

2 of 3: tomorrow start the letter drill with t and add one /t/ thumbs-up round (toe, sock, tape).

Not yet

0 or 1: tomorrow add 3 extra minutes (in class a small group; at home just you and your child): t card, /t/, top, My turn, Our turn, Your turn, then clap 1- and 2-part words.